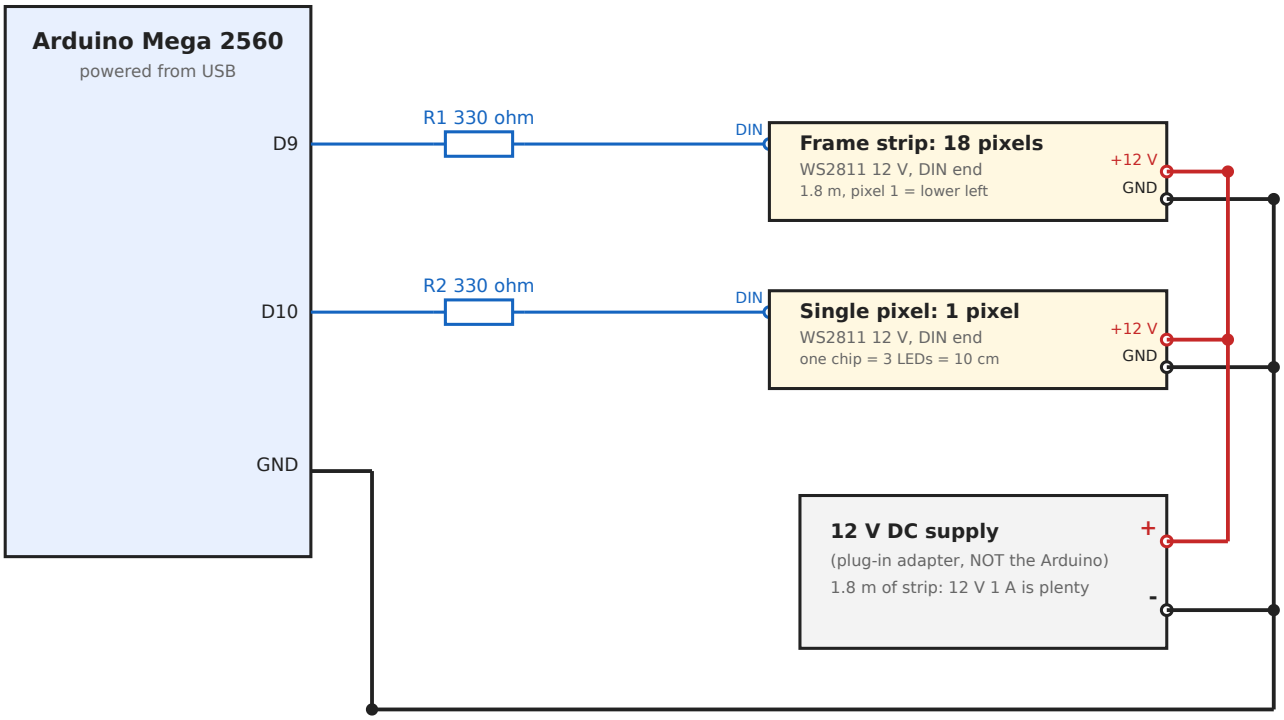
Strip frame demo test - wiring (Arduino Mega 2560 + two 12 V WS2811 strip pieces)



Connections

1. Arduino D9 -> 330 ohm resistor R1 -> DIN of the frame strip (18 pixels, the end where the printed arrows point away from).
2. Arduino D10 -> 330 ohm resistor R2 -> DIN of the single-pixel piece (one chip, 3 LEDs, cut from the same roll).
3. The +12 V of both strips comes from the 12 V supply, NEVER from an Arduino pin. No 12 V on any Arduino pin.
4. GND of the 12 V supply, GND of both strips and GND of the Arduino are connected together (common ground).
5. The Arduino is powered from USB (the Serial Monitor, 115200 baud, shows one DBG line per second).
6. Optional: a 1000 uF capacitor rated 25 V or more across +12 V and GND at the strip start (plus to +12 V).
7. The built-in LED (pin 13) blinks while the program runs.
8. Brightness peaks at 80 of 255 in the sketch (TEST_LEVEL); at most three lit pixels need very little current.